



SPIDER-MAN

PETER PARKER was an ordinary American teenager until a radioactive spider bit him and gave him the proportionate strength, speed, and agility of a spider. He also gained "spider-sense," which warned him of danger. At first he tried to cash in on his superpowers by becoming a television star. But when his uncle was murdered, he vowed to fight crime as Spider-Man.

FIRST FAILURE

Spider-Man was given the chance to join the Avengers—all he had to do was find the Hulk and bring him back to Avengers Mansion. After finding the Hulk, Spidey felt sorry for him when he learned he was really Bruce Banner, a tortured man unable to stop turning into the Hulk.

Second Failure

Learning that the Avengers each earned \$1,000 a week, Spider-Man again asked for membership. When his request was denied, he crept aboard a Quinjet and was soon helping the team repel a Lava Men invasion. Spider-Man proved a useful ally, but the government wouldn't let him join the Avengers, viewing him as a security risk.

Fourth Time Lucky

Spider-Man later helped the Avengers track down Nebula. After she was defeated, he became a reserve member of the team. Spider-Man finally gained acceptance with the New Avengers, of which he is a valued member.



One of Those Days

When Spider-Man offered to help Thor move some debris, the thunder god invited him to visit Avengers Mansion. Before long, the webhead was traveling across the galaxy, fighting space pirates and saving the universe!



SANDMAN

WHILE ESCAPING PRISON, William Baker hid on a beach and was accidentally exposed to intense radiation. His body merged with the radioactive sand and he was transformed into a living Sandman. Baker was a criminal for many years, before he decided to reform. He was duly invited to become a reserve member of the Avengers.

SAND TRAP

During his criminal days, the Sandman often fought Spider-Man. After going straight, he apologized to the webhead, and they became allies.

MASQUE

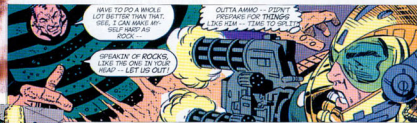
COUNTRESS GIULIETTA NEFARIA, daughter of Count Nefaria, took over his crime empire when he was jailed. Using the alias Whitney Frost, she tried to rob Stark Industries. The heist failed, however, and her face was scarred by chemicals during a plane crash.

The Midas Touch

Mordecai Midas, a power-hungry, ruthless criminal obsessed with gold, saved Giulietta's life and gave her a golden mask to hide her ruined face. An Olympic-level gymnast and athlete, martial artist and marksman, she began working for Midas as Madame Masque.

BEHIND THE MASK

Because of her disfigured face, the handsome Midas was the only man Masque felt comfortable with—until she met Tony Stark, alias Iron Man.



Here's Sand in Your Eye!

The Sandman can convert all or part of his body into sand. He can also mold himself into any shape he can imagine. His fists can become huge rock-hard hammers or sharp weapons. He can slither beneath a door frame or slip through a foe's fingers. He can also fire his sand particles at high velocities.



DIVIDED LOVE

Iron Man's passion for Masque often led to him having to choose between her and his duty. Although Masque went on missions with the Avengers, she later rejoined her father.

